Oct 16, 2025

Meeting Oct 16, 2025 at 15:30 CEST

Meeting records 🎬 Recording

Summary

Julius-Jonas Steffen successfully broadened a job search, and Clément Lacaille suggested using "AND" or "OR" operators and dynamically picking up search terms from OpenAI. Clément Lacaille and Julius-Jonas Steffen then successfully implemented a code node for filtering job results, which Naim Burrack, Kai Feldhoff, and Murphy Odion Usunobun also found effective, although they had to troubleshoot and fix an issue with the SER API node with help from Sven Lück. Clément Lacaille, Sven Lück, and Leon Winde also worked on debugging complex search queries in the SER API and using Gemini to format them. Clément Lacaille concluded by encouraging participants to practice and highlighting the importance of automation skills.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Perplexity Search Functionality** Julius-Jonas Steffen explained their successful attempt to broaden a job search beyond a specific city, noting the initial difficulty and hours of trial and error required to get the code to pull location and job values automatically, rather than requiring manual input, which was a concern raised previously. Clément Lacaille suggested trying to add "AND" or "OR" operators in search queries to get separate search words, advising Julius-Jonas Steffen to use "capital with spacing" for these operators to ensure they function correctly and to avoid receiving "no output". They also recommended exploring how the code could dynamically pick up job search terms from OpenAI rather than hardcoding them.

- **Progress and Volunteer Request** Clément Lacaille commended the group's rapid progress in learning AI, noting that they had reached a point in less than two weeks that took them three months personally. They requested a volunteer to lead the day's session, emphasizing the benefit of learning from different individuals and ensuring that participants actively practice by doing it themselves. Naim Burrack volunteered, despite Clément Lacaille's preference for a different person.
- **Volunteer Selection and Screen Sharing** After Naim Burrack volunteered, Clément Lacaille encouraged others to step forward, highlighting Naim Burrack's progress despite not having an automation background. When no one else volunteered, Clément Lacaille asked Julius-Jonas Steffen if they would like to drive the session, and Julius-Jonas Steffen agreed to try, leading to them sharing their screen.
- **Search Result Completion and Code Stage** Clément Lacaille conducted a quick poll to check how many participants had completed the search results phase and reached the code stage. They noted that some were two steps behind and encouraged participants to practice setting up the SER API on their own, emphasizing that the coding part should primarily organize information into a table format with only two key elements: job title and location.
- **HTTP Request and Manual Value Entry** Inken Maria Koch reported that their HTTP request was no longer working after the coding step and asked if they should delete the coding to follow along. Clément Lacaille advised Inken Maria Koch to manually type values for the HTTP node, such as "system administrator" or "HR," and continue with the class, with the understanding that they could fix the code after the session.
- **SER API Setup and Google Doc Sharing** Clément Lacaille requested Julius-Jonas Steffen to show their code output and the SER API setup for others to follow, suggesting that screenshots be posted in the Slack group for those who had not yet set it up. Clément Lacaille then shared a Google Doc link with the SER API detailed description, advising participants, particularly Inken Maria Koch, to manually enter basic job and location details if they faced issues, ensuring the node was connected to the OpenAI code.
- **Job Result Validation and Data Points** Clément Lacaille asked Julius-Jonas Steffen to show their search results and validate if the job results had valid links, which Julius-Jonas Steffen confirmed. They reviewed the content of the job

results, including title, company name, location, platform, and job link, noting that sometimes multiple links for the same job were collected. They also observed that while a "posted date" was available, salary information was typically not included.

- **JSON Data for Resume and Cover Letter** Clément Lacaille guided Julius-Jonas Steffen to review the structure of the job results JSON, focusing on the data points essential for customizing resumes and cover letters. Julius-Jonas Steffen identified key information such as job title, company name, location, posted date, full-time/part-time status, and job description, while noting that multiple platform links might not be necessary, with only one link being sufficient.
- **Prompting Perplexity for Code Generation** Clément Lacaille instructed Julius-Jonas Steffen to copy the JSON data and paste it into Perplexity, setting the model to Claude 4.5. They collaboratively crafted a prompt requesting Perplexity to organize the information into a table with specific columns: job title, company name, posted date, job description, apply option (platform and URL), type of job (full-time/part-time), and location. They ensured that each column was mapped to its corresponding key in the JSON data, such as `title` for job title and `extensions ` for posted date. Finally, they asked Perplexity to generate JavaScript code for the custom node function in N8N based on these instructions.
- **Code Implementation and Alternatives** Julius-Jonas Steffen pasted the generated JavaScript code into an N8N code node and executed it, confirming that the output was correct and well-organized. Naim Burrack requested the prompt and code to be shared in Slack for others to use. Kai Feldhoff presented an alternative using the "edit fields node" instead of a code node, which Clément Lacaille acknowledged as a valid approach, highlighting that N8N offers flexibility. Clément Lacaille further explained that while the "edit fields node" works for direct mapping, a code node offers more control for data cleaning and applying conditions if the output is not clean.
- **Troubleshooting and SER API Fix** Murphy Odion Usunobun encountered an issue where their code node produced no output, and Clément Lacaille guided them through troubleshooting. They discovered that the problem stemmed from the previous SER API node not returning any results due to invalid Q and location values. Sven Lück helped identify that adding a "Google_domain" parameter with the value "google.de" was crucial for searches specific to Germany to function

correctly. After applying this fix, Murphy Odion Usunobun's SER API started working, and the code node subsequently produced the desired output.

- **Meeting Agenda and Participant Check-in** Clément Lacaille reviewed the status of participants' progress, emphasizing the importance of following along, especially for those using the job results table. He specifically checked for those who had organized their job results into a table and were ready for the next step. Shivashanti_ reported difficulties trying to fix a problem and follow along simultaneously.
- **Troubleshooting Data Retrieval Issues** Clément Lacaille paused the class to help Shivashanti*, who was struggling with obtaining results despite successful node execution. Shivashanti* indicated that the issue might be due to an overly narrow exact match query, causing no results when using English search terms, contrasting with German terms. Clément Lacaille guided Shivashanti_ through checking node connections, adding parameters like `Google_domain` with value `google.de`, and ensuring credentials were correctly set up.
- **Resolving API Key Issues** Clément Lacaille continued to assist Shivashanti_ in resolving an API key issue, guiding them to sign into their SER API account and locate their API key. He suggested regenerating the API key and properly naming API keys for easier future retrieval. After trying these steps, Clément Lacaille noted that Shivashanti_'s API key appeared to be working, with seven searches already registered to the account.
- **Post-Troubleshooting Strategy** Clément Lacaille suggested that Shivashanti_ give the process another try after the class and encouraged them to use "complexity" to articulate their issue, expecting it might help them figure it out independently. He also offered to provide further assistance to those who remained stuck after the class. He also requested Julius-Jonas Steffen to resume the class to continue with the remaining parts of the workflow.
- **Filtering Job Results** Clément Lacaille and Julius-Jonas Steffen discussed filtering the job results, considering criteria like posted date and location. They decided to filter out jobs older than seven days and potentially exclude certain job titles like "netspec administrator," although Julius-Jonas Steffen personally did not mind including them. Julius-Jonas Steffen confirmed that most jobs in their search were full-time and in Hanover, simplifying some filtering aspects.
- **Exploring Filter Node Limitations** Clément Lacaille and Julius-Jonas Steffen attempted to use a filter node in N10 for job data, with Julius-Jonas Steffen

adding conditions based on posted date and job title. Naim Burrack also tried the filter method and reported that it did not work for them either. The filter node led to unexpected results, including filtering out everything or bringing in all results when conditions were changed.

- **Transitioning to Code Node for Filtering** Due to the difficulties with the filter node, Clément Lacaille suggested switching to a code node, acknowledging it as a more efficient way to filter data. Naim Burrack and Julius-Jonas Steffen also found the code node to be a more effective solution for filtering, with Julius-Jonas Steffen confirming that the code successfully filtered out unwanted job titles and older entries. Clément Lacaille advised participants that the exact code might need modification to fit their specific context and encouraged them to use perplexity to generate tailored code.
- **Progress Check and Volunteer Request** Clément Lacaille paused again to check on the class's progress, noting that some participants had dropped and others were still catching up. He specifically asked for a volunteer who had reached the SER API point and was ready to continue building the remaining workflow, as he would address individual SER API issues after class.
- **Next Steps: AI Agent and Company Research** Naim Burrack inquired about the next steps, and Clément Lacaille outlined plans to introduce an AI agent for company research. He described the next workflow as involving a system and user prompt for the AI agent, connecting it to Perplexity API as a research tool to generate a company report, and then linking it to another agent to generate a resume. Naim Burrack left the meeting with this information to attempt the next steps independently.
- **Troubleshooting Location Filtering with Sugandha** Sugandha Chandrashekhar Joshi shared their screen, showing that their SER API results were located in the USA instead of Germany, despite being logged in from Germany. Kai Feldhoff suggested adding a `gl` parameter with a `de` value, which Sugandha confirmed they had already done. Clément Lacaille identified that Sugandha had not included "location" as a parameter in their SER API query, which was causing the incorrect results. After adding "location" to the query, the results correctly showed locations within Germany.
- **Refining Filtering Criteria and Perplexity Integration** Clément Lacaille guided Sugandha Chandrashekhar Joshi on how to define filtering criteria for the jobs, suggesting they consider factors like posted date (e.g., within seven days) and

specific locations that are present in their current data. He then directed Sugandha to use Perplexity to generate JavaScript code for filtering the data based on these criteria, emphasizing that the code should be custom and based on the input from their previous code node.

- **Breakout Room for SER API Issues** Clément Lacaille offered to create a breakout room for those still struggling with SER API issues, with Sven Lück and Leon Winde volunteering to assist others in that room. He reiterated the importance of resolving SER API issues as they were foundational to the rest of the workflow. Sven Lück also mentioned a new official SER API node that could simplify the process, although Clément Lacaille noted he had experienced issues with it earlier.

- **Filter Criteria for Job Search** Clément Lacaille guided Sugandha Chandrashekhar Joshi on simplifying job search filter criteria by selecting one or two specific locations and ensuring the search string exactly matches the data, including case sensitivity. Sugandha Chandrashekhar Joshi was advised to change their filter criteria to only include jobs from a specific city that is present in the data.

- **Completing Today's Tasks and Tomorrow's Agenda** Clément Lacaille instructed participants to complete the filtering of job lists and post updates on their Slack group, emphasizing that they should finish the coding portion of the task. They also informed the class that they would continue building agents, including features like cover letter writing and company research, the following day. Clément Lacaille offered to stay after class the next day to assist anyone still struggling with the SER API.

- **Debugging Search Queries with SER API** Clément Lacaille and Sven Lück assisted Leon Winde in debugging issues with the SER API node, particularly when using complex search queries. They identified that the "Google_domain" setting was incorrectly set as "domain" for the key, and later concluded that complex queries mixing job titles and skills were causing negative results. Sven Lück noted that SER API struggles with complex queries, even if they would work in Google.

- **Using Gemini for Query Formatting** Clément Lacaille guided Leon Winde on how to use Gemini (presumably a public AI tool) to help format the search queries correctly for the SER API. They demonstrated how to prompt Gemini by explaining the issue of simple queries working but complex ones failing, and asking for the correct query format for multiple job titles.

- **Refining Search Query Strategy** Through testing various query formats with Leon Winde, Clément Lacaille and Sven Lück discovered that the SER API was not working when skills like "React" were included in the search query alongside job titles. They concluded that the mix of job titles and skills was causing negative results and advised Leon Winde to adjust their OpenAI system prompt to return only job titles, not skills, in the search query.
- **Importance of Practice and Automation Skills** Clément Lacaille encouraged participants to try the exercises themselves, emphasizing that even if it seems challenging, building the first automation workflow provides significant confidence. They highlighted that automation skills, especially with tools like N8N and building agent workflows, provide a considerable advantage in the job market, as agents represent the future of work.

Suggested next steps

- [ ] Julius-Jonas Steffen will go back and change the search query to add `and` between keywords with capital letters and spacing, like `system administrator and IT administrator`, to improve search results.
- [ ] Murphy Odion Usunobun will fix the previous code node after the class.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will ensure the workflow is completed with the group by tomorrow and assist those who are stuck after class today or tomorrow.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will continue from tomorrow the remaining part of the class.
- [ ] Julius-Jonas Steffen will paste the code in the Slack group.
- [ ] Naim Burrack will try to complete the remaining part of the workflow.
- [ ] Sven Lück will stay back after the class to help those struggling with SER API.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will stay back after class tomorrow to help those struggling with the SER API node and join a couple of minutes early to help Shivashanti.
- [ ] Sugandha Chandrashekhar Joshi will simplify the filter criteria by picking one or two locations for the jobs and figure out the query, get the results, then ask how to filter it or what is the code for filtering this.
- [ ] Chinedu Kirian Onwuzuruike will watch the class recordings and try to catch up with the class.
- [ ] Leon Winde will change the OpenAI system prompt to return only job titles, not skills, as part of the search query.

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